NOVEMBER 2005

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

CHINESE LIVES IN EARLY MOUNTAIN VIEW

PRESENTED BY: MS. BECKY McREYNOLDS

SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 6, 2005 AT 2:00 PM

Ms. McReynolds is an 'Asian Civilization' instructor at DeAnza Community College in Cupertino. This discussion will be based upon a study and thesis that Ms. McReynolds wrote for her Master's degree from Stanford. It documents and describes the earliest settlement of Chinese in Mountain View by piecing together the story of Yuen Lung, his family and business connections with early residents, such as Jake Mockbee, who provided personal and financial assistance. The author will discuss new evidence of a vibrant Chinese community with networks stretching throughout California as well as into other parts of the U.S. and China.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE BY NICK GALIOTTO

What a pleasure it was to represent the Historical Association on September 24 at the commemoration of the Mountain View Library's 100 years of service to our community. And, Barbara Kinchen was on hand to make sure the stories related by the various speakers about the Library coincided with its actual history. It was a very enjoyable program that included the planting of a Centennial Crabapple tree, since such a tree had grown next to the earlier library building.

The ad hoc committee studying the feasibility of establishing a Mountain View History Museum has been busy. Wally Erichsen reports that they have visited the local museums in nearby cities and gathered a lot of information. A mission statement for the committee has been developed. The committee consists of Wally, Anne Bakotich, Al Jehning, Barbara Kinchen, Vivian Schatz, John Viscovich, and Bob Weaver. If any other members are interested in joining this committee, Wally says that you're most welcome.

Hip Telmont again coordinated the MVHA's participation in the recent Chamber of Commerce Art & Wine Festival. Those of you that worked with Hip on this definitely gave our organization a positive presence at another major community event. Also, of course, it was an opportunity to sell a few books and to sign up several new members, which is always a plus for our organization.

Your Executive Committee met on September 7th to plan the association's final activities for this year. (Wow, this year is almost over). And, we give Trudi Tuban a very big "thank you" for all that's involved in getting the Newsletter to our members.

Once again, my standard closing: Encourage your friends to attend our meetings. They will learn of Mountain View's colorful past and mingle with some of those that have lived it. That's what we're about. See you on November 6th!!

KUDOS TO BBQ AND RAFFLE VOLUNTEERS BY CRAIG HOLDEN

Listed below are members commended for their loyal service in making our August 2005 BBQ and Raffle a success. Many of these individuals have performed their BBQ "Task" for many years:

Trudi Tuban: reservation forms.
Wally Erichsen: process reservations, name tags, register guests.
Margaret Peterson: letters to solicit & to acknowledge Raffle donations.
John Viscovich & Margaret Peterson: procure food.
Hip Telmont: set up and take down tables and chairs.
Al and Audrey Jehning: BBQers (table number system by Audrey.)
Matt Neely, Mayor, & Matt Pear, City Council: Assistant BBQers.
Donna Martin, Trudi Tuban, Dorothy Rich, Chuck Thompson, Margaret Peterson: kitchen crew, prep, serving and clean up.
Edna Thompson: raffle tickets, sales & equipment.
Alex Fucile: raffle ticket sales.
Nick Galiotto: raffle caller and auctioneer, assisted by Matt Neely.

Thank you folks, and thanks to all those who came to the BBQ. My apologies for any omissions or errors.

NOTE: The *List of Association Officers and Executive Officers* and *The Income and Expense Statement* has been omitted to keep the newsletter to four pages. The Income and Expense Statement balance as of September 6, 2005 was $35,071.81.

DONATIONS FOR THE BBQ RAFFLE

Book Buyers, 317 Castro Street, Mountain View 94040
Hobee's Restaurant, 2312 Central Expressway, Mountain View 94043
Image Makers Styling Salon, 1764 Miramonte Ave., Mountain View 94040
Country Gourmet Restaurant, corner of Rengstorff & El Camino, Mountain View 94041
Burger King, 100 W. El Camino #76, Mountain View 94040
Mountain View Center for Performing Arts, 500 Castro Street, Mountain View 94041
Shoreline Billiards, 1400 N. Shoreline Blvd. #C, Mountain View 94043
Armadillo Willy's Restaurant, 997 Acacia Avenue, Los Altos 94022
Shoreline Golf Links, 2940 N. Shoreline Blvd., Mountain View 94043
El Camino YMCA, 2400 Grant Road, Mountain View 94040
Sunnymount Produce, 1101 W. El Camino, Sunnyvale 94087

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 YEARS AGO (1905): **McDonald and Burke, Blacksmiths, built a new place of business in the 300 block of Castro and were moving equipment from their former location at Castro and Villa Streets.**

The Train Depot was described as "dreary." The old buildings were surrounded with weeds and dust in the summer and weeds and mud holes in the winter. The newspaper editor suggested a public park be considered for the area between the station and Castro Street.

50 YEARS AGO (1955): **The new Los Altos High School opened in September and First Western Bank moved from 201 Castro to new quarters at 565 Castro. Plans were announced for a bowling alley on Gemello's El Camino property.**

Based on a novel by James Edmiston, Jr., of Palo Alto, a movie, "Home Again," about a Japanese family returning to their flower-growing business in Mountain View after 3-1/2 years internment at Heart Mountain, Wyoming. Background scenes were being shot around Mountain View. (Does anyone have personal knowledge about this movie?)

Widespread wind damage, power outages, flooding and evacuations occurred throughout Northern California in a series of storms the week before Christmas. There were deaths; with most lost in the levee break at Yuba City. In Mountain View, both Permanente and Stevens Creeks caused flooding, along with especially high tides. Parts of Bayshore Highway were closed as well as the El Camino-El Monte Intersection. The North Bayshore area was hard hit and the city dump was under water.

25 YEARS AGO (1980): **Mountain View-Los Altos High School District trustees, acting on Superintendent Paul Sakamoto's recommendation, voted to close the Castro Street high school in June 1981.**

Victor Calvo was honored upon retirement from the California State Legislature. His 22 years of public service included councilman, county supervisor, three terms at the state level and member of the California Public Utilities Commission.

The Italian Catholic Federation of Mountain View held a testimonial dinner for Ugo Mancini for his many accomplishments and services to the community.

The president of Trinity College, Washington D.C., traveled to Portland, Oregon to personally present a graduation certificate to a lady who had been "too busy" to pick it up some 76 years before. Mrs. Jessie Johnson Fretz, age 100, a former resident of Mountain View, was that lady. (Jessie Lane is named for Mrs. Fretz and Paul Avenue for her son, Paul Fretz.)

Open house was held in the new Police and Fire Administration Building on Villa Street.

After being vacant ten years, there was finally an agreement to finish and lease out the International Environmental Design Building (IED) at Castro and Mercy Streets.

Neighbors protested the noise from mock bull fights and other events put on by rental groups, including Hells Angels, at the I.F.E.S. Portuguese property on Stierlin Road.

Arrow Development, makers of the Boomerang, Corkscrew, Lock Ness Monster and Logger's Run amusement park rides, was bought by Huss Trading Corporation of Switzerland. Operations are to be moved to Salt Lake City and to Germany.

STREET TALK BY BARBARA KINCHEN

What street is named for one of Mountain View's early Baptist ministers? Reverend Orrin Crittenden (1814-1903), came to our area in 1853 and owned 160 acres where Crittenden Lane runs from Shoreline Boulevard, east to Stevens Creek. Crittenden Middle School is named for Reverend Crittenden's adopted son, Albert M. Crittenden. Albert owned the family land until it sold and became part of Moffett Field in 1929.

NEW QUESTION

The following streets appear together in one neighborhood -- College Street, University Avenue, Stanford Avenue and Leland Avenue. What is that area of Mountain View called?

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORY CENTER

From member Connie Wellington: Mountain View High School Yearbooks for 1964-1968.

From member Patricia Allen Scheid: A 1949 burning permit issued to her father on Springer Road and signed by Fire Chief Clarence Lawson. A copy of the wedding certificate for Isadore Roux and Ramona Virginia Vosti who were married in 1927 by Father Galvin at St. Joseph's Catholic Church in Mountain View.

From Bob French of Palo Alto: Copy of 1870 census for Fremont Township, the area now within Palo Alto, Mountain View, Los Altos, Cupertino and Sunnyvale.

From member Glenn "Hank" Wilson: Copies of photos from the Wilson family collection, all undated. (1) Photos of the Valley Electric Store at 275 Castro Street and the adjoining Peterson Plumbing Shop. Valley Electric Company was established by Hank's father, Glenn Wilson, Sr. in the mid-1920s and remained in the same location for many years. (2) Early interior shot of Valley Electric Store. (3) Old storage building on alley behind Valley Electric. It was once used as the Swall Butcher Shop at the corner of Castro and Villa; it had been moved up the street for Mr. Peterson's Plumbing Shop and later moved to the alley when Peterson had a new building constructed.

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE REPORT

The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee met on September 7, 2005. Discussions were held concerning new donations to the History Room, the August BBQ, progress of the History Center Committee, and the upcoming Art and Wine Festival. It was approved to purchase a portable sound system for our meetings.

MEMBERSHIP REPORT BY JUNE CASEY

Life Members	121	
Honored Member	1	
Family Membership	130	
Single Membership	101	
TOTAL		353

New A/S Member: **Jacqueline Bordi**
New A/F Members: **Barbara and Philip Gooding**
New Life Members**: Marco Bertozzi, Patricia Diaz, Eileen O'Halloran, Carol Rudgers, Jac Siegel and Sharon Siegel**

PLEASE USE THE ATTACHED ENVELOPE TO SEND IN YOUR 2006 DUES.

NOTE: **The *"Memorial"* section had nothing to report this quarter.**

Mountain View
Historical
Association

Regular Meeting

Ms. Becky Reynolds
Presenting

CHINESE LIVES IN EARLY MOUNTAIN VIEW

Sunday, November 6, 2005
- 2:00 P.M.
The Adobe Building
Moffett Blvd and
Central Express Way

MEMBERSHIP: *Any person who signifies interest in the Aims of this Association and who pays the specified dues May become a member of this Association.*

AIMS: *The aims of this Association are: to gather and Preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View, to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our organization.*

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION:

Name: _____

Address: _____

_____

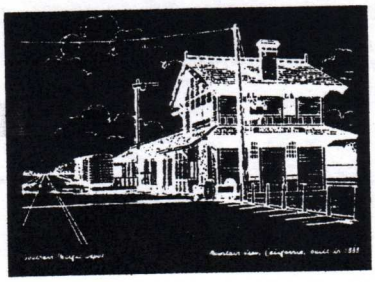
Telephone: _____

Type Membership: NEW _____RENEWAL_____
____ Regular Membership, $7.00/year
____ Family Membership, $10/year
____ Life Member, $100.00
Please make Check Payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View CA 94042

Mountain View
Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

MOUNTAIN VIEW CA OCT 21 '05 PB METER 8350491 ≈ 0.37 ≈ U.S. POSTAGE

first class mail



6

94041#1942